

General Science





About the Course

Students explore habitats primarily through practical observation and 'meet' some less familiar creatures from those habitats, such as bats, spiders, and seeds, through picture books. Coordinating afternoon activities are provided in Outdoor Work.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 1

About Science: Grade 1

In Level 1, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through the most accessible Things, simple text, and basic concepts.

Science: Grade 1

The Big Picture:

To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in Grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just 'feels right.' Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).



Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 1

In Level 1, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through the most accessible Things, simple text, and basic concepts.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	General Science: Grade 1 1 time/week 15 min	A Fruit is a Suitcase for Seeds A House Spider's Life Over and Under the Pond Up in the Garden and Down in the Dirt Winter Sleep: A Hibernation Story Bat Loves the Night

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 1				
Natural History: Grade 1 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	Nature Notebook: Grade 1		General Science: Grade 1	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 1

- ☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
- ☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:

- ☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
- ☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 1

- ☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
- ☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

General Science: Grade 1

- Term 1: Insects, flowers, and bats, evenings, and a pond
- Term 2: Seeds and animal homes, evenings, and a pond
- Term 3: Spiders, birds, and flowers, evenings, and a pond

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Science: Grade 1

Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

General Science: Grade 1

- ☐ Term 1: Bats p.241-244, in addition to ants p.369-374 and bees p.384-395
- ☐ Term 2: Bird feathers p.29-31, and/or attracting birds p.43-44, in addition to squirrels p.233-237
- ☐ Term 3: Spiders p.435-447 and/or choose one of your garden flowers on p.546-590
- ☐ Gather household items, typically easy for students to scavenge or teachers to obtain locally:
 - 12-18" piece of substrate (recycled cardboard, wood scrap, foam core)
 - found nature objects
 - various fruits, such as pit fruit (cherry, plum, peach, apricot, avocado), many-seeded fruit (lemon, melon, apple, pear), many-many seeds (banana, kiwi, berry), pea pod, ear of corn (Term 2)
 - pot/planter with soil or place in the ground with trowel to dig
 - any seedlings or flower seeds (Term 3)
 - optional: craft paint

Reminders

General Science: Grade 1

- ☐ Fresh fruits are required for Term 2 Week 8. Make a note on your calendar to obtain these at the appropriate time.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Science: Grade 1



A Fruit is a Suitcase for Seeds



A House Spider's Life



Over and Under the Pond



Up in the Garden and Down in the Dirt



Winter Sleep: A Hibernation Story



Bat Loves the Night



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

General Science: Grade 1



Crayola Model Magic Dough



Household Items - General Science: Grade 1



Wild Bird Seed



Bird Feeder



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text](#)
[or scan the QR](#)
[code for links.](#)



General Science: Grade 1

How To Teach



Introduce

- Begin each lesson with learners' existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to help discuss what students think, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap. The lesson plans often help with this.
- Some learners may benefit from using pictures or looking back briefly.
- Allow them time to share any concerns and come alongside, as needed.



Complete

- Read, or do, as instructed in the lessons, noting any Teacher Tips provided. Learners should always have their nature journal or some other notebook/paper available in case they need to draw or diagram during the lesson.
- When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try to show them with a picture or connect the idea to something they have seen in real life. They are learning much by the way and will likely build understanding over the term, the year, or beyond.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling the events in sequence, describing a scene or setting, explaining a concept, etc.
- Learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.



Discuss

- Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.
- Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. If teachers want to keep ideas active in the mind, these can also be used at other times to keep the ideas in the working memory.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc., depending on learner interest.
- These can also be viewed as alternative ways to engage.

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 1

Listening to the Chorus Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

When we observe, we can use all our senses, but we often rely on sight more than our other senses. Use your time today to sit and just listen to the sounds of nature.

→ LISTEN

Find a place to sit where you can hear the sounds of nature. Sit in a comfortable position, maybe with your eyes closed. Listen for about 7-10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student heard.

- What sounds were the loudest? What sounds did you hear most often? Were there any that you had to listen very closely to hear? Do you know who you heard? Do you know where they live?

★ TEACHER TIP

If students seem anxious or unsure about their Nature Journals, teachers can encourage them by modeling, showing them many different examples, journaling in tandem, or serving as a scribe.

WEEK 2 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 2

Pond Habitat

Materials: Over and Under the Pond

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on the cover. The creatures that we see and hear outside all have homes just like us! These homes are called habitats. Let's read a book today about one habitat, called a pond. If you have been to a pond, tell about or draw one thing that stood out to you. Did you ever think about a pond as someone's home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Over and Under the Pond (whole book)

- If you have visited a pond before, who do you remember seeing there? If not, what or who do you hope to see when we visit?

★ TEACHER TIP

Let students enjoy the artwork in this picture book. If you need to take a break and finish it another time, that is fine.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 3 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 3

Same Creatures, Different Homes Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Some creatures live in only one particular habitat, while others live in many different habitats. Today let's notice creatures that live in many different habitats.

→ OBSERVE

Spend about 10 minutes noticing creatures around home/school that also live at the pond. These could be insects, squirrels, and even trees or grasses.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Did you notice any creatures that live both at home/school AND at the pond? If so, how do you think their lives are different in these different habitats? If not, why do you suppose not?

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 4

Looking for Ants Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Today, you will look for ants. Some good places to look are under small rocks, under loose bark, and in cracks.

→ OBSERVE

Use a stick to safely lift rocks and bark. If you find ants, take some time to observe them. If you find someone else that you want to observe, you may take the time to do so. Spend about 10 minutes looking for ants.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Did you find ants? Some other interesting creature? Tell about their habitat: where is it? What is around? What was the creature doing? Do they have a nest? If so, how do you know? Did you notice eggs, larvae, or pupae? Did they carry food? Do you notice how they entered or left their home?

★ TEACHER TIP

This week or next is a great opportunity to do an object lesson during the science activity. Questions are embedded in the lesson to help, as needed. If preferred, teachers can instead refer to the Handbook of Nature Study or allow questions to flow naturally between student and teacher.

WEEK 5 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 5

Looking for Ants Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Look for ants again this week or return to visit your ants again, if you found some last week.

→ OBSERVE

Is anything different this week? If you find an ant, carefully take a closer look at its body, being careful not to disturb a nest; you might place an ant in a container temporarily and look at it with a magnifier. How many parts of the body can you count? How many legs? From which parts do the legs come? How many antennae does it have? How does it use its antennae? Spend about 10 minutes looking for/watching ants.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

WEEK 6 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 6

Noticing Bees Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Look for other insects this week, especially bees.

→ OBSERVE

Spend about 10 minutes noticing insects. What are they doing? What parts of the body can you see? How would you describe the habitat?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- How is this bee (or other insect) similar to and different from the ant?

★ TEACHER TIP

The bees will begin slowing down toward the end of fall. Notice if this is happening, as you might get to see one up close and do an object lesson!

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 7

Noticing Bees Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Look for bees again this week.

→ OBSERVE

Is anything different this week? Do you find the same type of bee, a different type, or none at all? Some other type of insect? Spend about 10 minutes noticing.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 8 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 8

Meeting an Evening Creature

Materials: Bat Loves the Night

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

One creature that you may have noticed in the evening is the bat. Have you ever seen a bat? If so, what did you notice about them? Briefly describe in words or a picture. Bats need very particular types of habitats. They are also very important helpers to many other creatures. Let's read and find out more.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Bat Loves the Night (whole book)

- What kinds of things do you think the bat needs in its habitat?

★ TEACHER TIP

Let students enjoy the artwork in this picture book. If you need to take a break and finish it another time, that is fine.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 9 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 9

Noticing Sound Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

It can be hard to understand exactly how a bat uses echolocation because we don't share that experience, but we can think about how different sounds sound different.

→ ACTIVITY

Choose three different objects, such as a penny, a bead, and a small ball of paper. Drop these three objects onto three different surfaces to hear the sound that bounces back to your ear, such as a metal pan, the floor, and a countertop or desk. Do you think you could learn to tell these apart if you couldn't see them? Spend about 10 minutes listening and describing what you hear.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 10

Modeling a Pond Habitat Activity

☐ Materials: Clay, 12-18" piece of substrate, e.g., cardboard, wood scrap, foam core, found nature objects, optional: craft paint

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

What are some things you have learned about ponds this term? Let's use the last 2 weeks of the term to create a model of a pond habitat. You will use clay to form your pond, paint if desired, and then you can use found nature objects to add the plants and animals that live there.

→ ACTIVITY

∞ Website Link: Salt Dough Recipe (as an alternative to clay)

★ TEACHER TIP

Students may need to work on their models in the afternoon if they need extra time.

WEEK 11 ☐ 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 11

Modeling a Pond Habitat Activity

☐ Materials: Clay, found nature objects, optional: craft paint

→ ACTIVITY

Complete the pond habitat model.

∞ Website Link: Salt Dough Recipe (as an alternative to clay)

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Over and Under the Pond

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 13

Habitats in Winter

Materials: Winter Sleep

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Does your home or the way you live change in the winter? Look at the picture on the cover. What do you think happens to the creatures' habitats when the seasons change? How do plants and animals get ready for winter? Briefly describe in words or a picture.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Winter Sleep: A Hibernation Story (whole book)

You may leave the end matter for another time based on student interest.

- Have you ever come across an animal that was sleeping for the winter? If so, what did you notice? What do you notice the non-hibernating animals doing in the winter? What happens to plants in winter?

★ TEACHER TIP

Let students enjoy the artwork in this picture book. If you need to take a break and finish it another time, that is fine.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 2 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 14

Providing for Animals in Winter Activity

Materials: Bird feeder and/or sticks/logs/leaves

→ ACTIVITY

Before it gets too cold, put up a bird feeder (purchased or homemade) and/or build a simple stick/log/leaf pile.

∞ Website Link: Fun DIY Bird Feeders

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note that students should collect a variety of wild seeds over the next couple of weeks, as prompted in their Nature Notebook suggestions. These are for Wk 5 Lsn 50 and Wk 10 Lsn 65.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 3 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 15

Noticing Animal Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Spend about 10 minutes watching animal behavior during this time of seasonal change.

→ OBSERVE

What are the animals doing? Is anyone visiting your feeder or pile?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP

If students seem anxious or unsure about their Nature Journals, teachers can encourage them by modeling, showing them many different examples, journaling in tandem, or serving as a scribe.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 4 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 16

Noticing Animal Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Spend about 10 minutes watching animal behavior during this time of seasonal change.

★ TEACHER TIP

Animals that come to your feeder or pile provide a great opportunity to do an object lesson during the science activity.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ OBSERVE

What are the animals doing? Is anyone visiting your feeder or pile?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- What was different this week compared to last week?

WEEK 5 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 17

Looking Closely at Seeds Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Choose at least one of the collected seeds to draw/paint today. Look closely at it before you begin. What do you notice? How is this seed built? Does it remind you of anything else? Does it give you an idea as to how the seed spreads for planting? Does an animal eat it? Does it hold on to an animal to ride along? Does it ride on the wind?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you recorded. Do you know the name of the plant that made this seed?

★ TEACHER TIP

This is a great opportunity to do an object lesson during the science activity.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 6 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 18

Noticing Animal Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Spend about 10 minutes watching animal behavior during this time of seasonal change.

→ OBSERVE

What are the animals doing? Is anyone visiting your feeder or pile?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- What was different this week compared to previous weeks?

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 7 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 19

Thinking about Seeds

Materials: A Fruit is a Suitcase for Seeds

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

What kinds of fruit do you like to eat? Do you know what kind of plant makes your fruit? Why does the plant make fruit? Look at the picture on the cover. Does your fruit have seeds?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

A Fruit is a Suitcase for Seeds (whole book)

- What do you think happens to seeds in nature when an animal eats the fruit? Do all plants that make seeds package them inside fruit? What about the seed you drew/painted last week? Did it have a fruit?

★ TEACHER TIP

Let students enjoy the artwork in this picture book. If you need to take a break and finish it another time, that is fine.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Students will need a variety of fruits to examine their seeds next week.



Term 2

WEEK 8 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 20

Investigating Fruits Activity

 Materials: Nature Journal, a variety of fruits with seeds

→ INTRO

Have you ever noticed the different kinds of seeds in the fruit you eat? Let's investigate today!

→ ACTIVITY

Open a pit fruit (cherry, plum, peach, apricot, avocado), a many-seeded fruit (lemon, melon, apple, pear), a many-many seeded fruit (banana, kiwi, berry), a pea pod, and an ear of corn to find the seeds. Look closely and compare them. How are they different from each other? How are they similar? When you are finished, choose one or more that you would like to plant. Wash them and lay them on a towel to dry.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.
• Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

WEEK 9 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 21

Noticing Animal Activity

 Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Spend about 10 minutes watching animal behavior during this time of seasonal change.

→ OBSERVE

What are the animals doing? Is anyone visiting your feeder or pile?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.
• What was different this week compared to previous weeks?

WEEK 10 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 22

Looking Closely at Seeds Activity

 Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Draw/paint a seed today.

→ OBSERVE

Choose another of the collected seeds to draw/paint today. Look closely at it before you begin. What do you notice?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.
• How does this compare to the seeds obtained from fruits that you eat? Do you think an animal eats this seed? If not, does the seed offer any clues as to how it might spread, so that it can grow? What is its shape? What is its texture?

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 11 **15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 23**

Planting a Seed Activity

Materials: Pot, soil, seed, water

→ **ACTIVITY**

Plant one or more of the fruit seeds that you saved. Plant it as deep as the seed is wide and give it just enough water to dampen the soil. You will need to continue to keep the soil moist, but not wet, over break. When your seed germinates, place the pot near a window where it will receive sunlight.

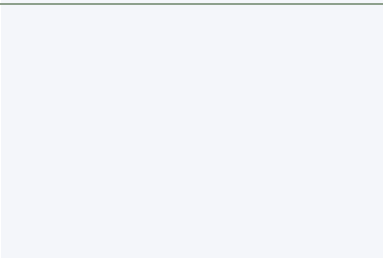
WEEK 12 **15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 24**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
A Fruit is a Suitcase for Seeds



General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 25

Bird Watching Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Today we will notice the birds.

→ OBSERVE

Spend about 10 minutes bird watching. What colors, markings, and shapes do you notice? What are they doing?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Do you notice anyone already familiar to you? Do you notice anyone new?

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 2 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 26

Garden Habitat

Materials: Up in the Garden and Down in the Dirt

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on the cover. Have you ever thought about your yard or garden as a habitat? Do you already know some creatures who live there?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Up in the Garden and Down in the Dirt (whole book)

- Have you seen or heard any of the creatures in the story before? Are there any that you think would be interesting?

★ TEACHER TIP

Let students enjoy the artwork in this picture book. If you need to take a break and finish it another time, that is fine.

WEEK 3 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 27

Preparing the Garden Activity

Materials: Pot with soil or patch of ground, seeds or seedlings, water

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ ACTIVITY

Help prepare a small garden - even a single pot can be a habitat! Plant some seeds/seedlings, or transplant the one that sprouted last term. Remember that you will need to check on it regularly to pull a weed or provide water, as needed.

★ TEACHER TIP

It can help to set a reminder in your calendar while students are forming the habit of caring for their garden.

WEEK 4 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 28

Bird Watching Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Today we will notice the birds.

→ OBSERVE

Spend about 10 minutes bird watching. What colors, markings, and shapes do you notice? What are they doing?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Do you notice anyone already familiar to you? Do you notice anyone new?

WEEK 5 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 29

Critter Investigation Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, garden trowel, piece of ground to dig

→ INTRO

We have spent time noticing creatures in the sky and on the surface of the earth, but what about under the surface? Does anyone live there?

→ OBSERVE

Spend about 10 minutes digging in the dirt or leaf litter to see who is busy under the surface. If you see a pill bug, what does it do when you pick it up? If you see a worm, how does it feel in your hand? Who is the first visitor up above the surface?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you recorded.

WEEK 6 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 30

Wildflower Watching Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Today we will spend about 10 minutes noticing which wildflowers are growing in your yard this season.

→ OBSERVE

What colors and shapes do you notice? Where are they growing? Describe the land and any plants or animals you notice around them. Compare any wildflowers to those growing in the garden. In what ways are they similar or different?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Do you notice anyone already familiar to you? Do you notice anyone new?

★ TEACHER TIP

Flower observation is always a great time for an object lesson!

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 7 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 31

Meeting an 8-Legged Creature

Materials: A House Spider's Life

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on the cover. What kinds of spiders have you noticed before? What did they look like? Where were they? Did they have a web?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

A House Spider's Life (whole book)

- The next time you notice a spider, what part of the spider or web do you think you might want to look at more closely?

★ TEACHER TIP

If you are blessed with a spider in a convenient location, take the opportunity for an object lesson and observe it regularly.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 8 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 32

Noticing Spiders Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Look for spiders this week. They may be active in grass or wooded areas or in garages or basements where they overwintered. If you don't come across a spider, then just observe whatever nature has provided today!

→ OBSERVE

Is this a spider that you have noticed before? How is it similar or different to the one in your book? How many body segments do you see? How many legs does it have? How many eyes does it have? What colors, markings, or textures do you see? Does it have a web? If so, describe the shape and construction of the web.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP

If you know where a spider has built a web, do an object lesson! If students struggle to find them, it's okay. Just encourage them to pursue the nature mystery - if the spiders aren't where we have looked, where could they be? Why aren't they here?

• NATURE NOTEBOOK

Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 9 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 33

Bird Watching Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip.

→ INTRO

Take some time to notice what birds are visiting today.

→ OBSERVE

Spend about 10 minutes bird watching. What colors, markings, and shapes do you notice? What are they doing?

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Do you notice anyone already familiar to you? Do you notice anyone new?

★ TEACHER TIP

If birds are visiting a feeder, use the opportunity to do an object lesson.

WEEK 10 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 34

Wildflower Watching Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO

Today we will spend about 10 minutes noticing which wildflowers are growing in your yard this season.

→ OBSERVE

How many different colors can you find today? Describe the flowers, as well as any plant or critter neighbors. Compare the wildflower to any flowers already growing in the garden.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed.

- Do you notice anyone already familiar to you? Do you notice anyone new?

General Science: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 35 Noticing Spiders Activity Materials: Nature Journal → INTRO Look for spiders again this week. You could revisit a spider that you have already met, or maybe meet someone new! → OBSERVE Describe the colors, markings, and surroundings of any spiders you notice. → NARRATE & DISCUSS Use a Nature Journal to record what the student noticed. • Tell about what you found or what you recorded.	• NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.
WEEK 12 15m General Science: Grade 1 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Up in the Garden and Down in the Dirt	

General Science: Grade 1

Examination

- Term 1** · Over and Under the Pond: Tell about or draw a pond habitat with five things that live there.
- Term 2** · A Fruit is a Suitcase for Seeds: Tell about or draw three seeds that you looked at this term.
- Term 3** · Up in the Garden and Down in the Dirt: Tell about or draw a garden habitat, including at least five creatures that live in it.